



Outcome vs Output Tracking

Week 7 • Day 3 • Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery

TPM Academy



Day 3 Objectives

- Build **output / outcome / leading-indicator triples** for each meaningful output
- Design the **sprint-level tracking** with a leading-indicator dashboard
- Design the **monthly outcome review** with named author + audience
- Design the **quarterly NS roll-up**
- Add **AI pattern detection** as a sprint-review aid



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin DP Sections 1–2
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Output / outcome / leading-indicator triples
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Sprint-level tracking
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	Monthly + quarterly templates
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Build Section 3 + AI pattern detection

Block 1 — The Triple

Output / Outcome / Leading indicator



5 Tracking-Plan Failures

Failure	Symptom
Output-only	"12 stories shipped." Nobody asks if anything moved.
Lagging-only	First feedback at 90 days — too late.
Vanity-only	DAU went up — from what?
No counter-metric	Metric moved up the wrong way (gaming).
Dashboard-without-action	Beautiful charts; no decisions change.



The Triple

Output	Outcome	Leading indicator
Reconcile mobile flow	Median reconcile 45 → 12 min in 30d	First-attempt completion $\geq 80\%$ by week 2
Auto-suggest top 5	Time-to-select 30 → 10s	% using suggestion $\geq 50\%$ by week 4
Audit publishing	SOC 2 Q3 review passes	Event volume + DLQ depth steady through week 4

Leading indicator = the early signal. Without it, you wait 30 days to learn the outcome failed. A dead-letter queue (DLQ) depth reading is one such early signal.

Activity 1 — Build Triples

Quads • 35 minutes

- 10 min: list 5–8 outputs from Delivery Plan (DP) Section 2
- 10 min: name outcome per output
- 10 min: name leading indicator per outcome
- 5 min: each leading indicator measurable within 7 days?



10 + 10 + 10 + 5

Block 2 — Sprint-Level Tracking

Outputs and outcomes inspected together



Tracking Cadence

Cadence	Audience	What's reviewed
Daily	Engineers / on-call	Alerts; error budget; immediate breaks
Sprint (2w)	Quad + eng lead	Velocity + leading indicators
Monthly	TPM + PM director	Outcome metrics
Quarterly	Quad + leadership	NS movement; KPI roll-up

If a metric has no cadence, it has no audience. The quarterly key performance indicator (KPI) roll-up is one such metric.



Sprint Review Structure

1. What shipped (outputs)
2. What's still open
3. Velocity
4. **Leading indicators** — which moved, which didn't
5. Anomalies
6. Adjustments for next sprint

The TPM-owned twist: at least one segment is about *outcome*, not output.

Activity 2 — Sprint-Level Tracking

Quads • 40 minutes

- 15 min: design sprint review template (6 sections)
- 5 min: cadence anchor (day, time, recurring)
- 15 min: leading indicator dashboard (3–5 charts)
- 5 min: thresholds + actions per chart



15 + 5 + 15 + 5

Block 3 — Monthly + Quarterly

Outcome reviews + NS roll-up



Monthly Outcome Review

```
## Monthly Outcome Review – <feature>

### The primary outcome
Baseline / Current / Target / Status (●/●/●)

### Supporting outcomes
[same table]

### Counter-outcomes (the guardrails)
[same table]

### What we learned this month
2-3 bullets – surprises, model changes

### Decisions for next month
3-5 specific decisions: invest more / pivot / stop
```

"Decisions for next month" is what makes the review **actionable** rather than ceremonial.



Quarterly NS Roll-Up

Did the feature contribute to the NS?

- Did the primary outcome move?
- Did supporting outcomes contribute?
- Did counter-outcomes stay flat?
- Did the NS itself move? (Often hard to attribute to one feature; that's fine — name what you can.)

Honest attribution beats over-claiming.

Activity 3 — Monthly + Quarterly

Quads • 40 minutes

- 15 min: monthly review template
- 15 min: quarterly roll-up template
- 5 min: author + audience per template
- 5 min: cadence anchor per template



15 + 15 + 5 + 5

Block 4 — Section 3 + AI Pattern Detection

Combine sections; add the anomaly-spotting prompt



DP Section 3 Structure

```
## 3. Tracking plan

### Output / Outcome / Leading-Indicator triples
[Activity 1 table]

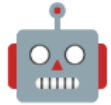
### Counter-metrics
[from NS Defense Card]

### Sprint-level tracking
- Cadence; template link; dashboard link; thresholds

### Monthly outcome review
- Cadence; template link; author/audience

### Quarterly NS roll-up
- Cadence; template link

### AI pattern detection
- Prompt link; frequency; validation rule
```



AI Pattern Detection Prompt

Feed the prompt your Azure DevOps (ADO) query results.

```
Role: Senior PM doing pattern detection across a sprint.  
Context: <ADO query results – items shipped, blocked,  
leading indicator readings>  
Task: Identify top 3 patterns:  
1. Leading indicator moving wrong direction (or flat)  
2. Category over- or under-represented this sprint  
3. Anomaly worth investigating  
Constraints:  
- Use only provided data  
- Name specific items / numbers  
- Suggest one investigation step per pattern  
Format: 3 numbered – pattern / evidence / suggested investigation.
```

Activity 4 — Section 3 + AI

Quads • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 15 min: combine into Section 3
- 10 min: AI prompt on synthetic sprint
- 10 min: validate
- 10 min: cross-review with another quad



15 + 10 + 10 + 10 • 15-min wrap



Day 3 Wrap

What we built

- Output/outcome/leading-indicator triples
- Sprint-level tracking + dashboard
- Monthly outcome review template
- Quarterly NS roll-up template
- AI pattern-detection pattern
- DP Section 3 drafted

What opens tomorrow

- **Lean delivery + value stream mapping**
- Lead time / process time / flow efficiency
- value stream mapping (VSM) canvas for the feature delivery

Bring to Day 4: DP Sections 1–3. Tomorrow we map the flow.

Questions & Reflection

What outcome will you know is failing within 7 days of launch?